

Stem Cells: Structured DISCUSS

I can write or dictate a structured DISCUSS judgement and improve it after feedback.

BOTH SIDES

benefit and risk

EVIDENCE

relevant, not decorative

EDIT

feedback changes the answer

[Open the original interactive lesson](#)

What success looks like

- I can include a potential benefit and a potential risk.
- I can distinguish evidence from an ethical value.
- I can reach a justified, cautious conclusion and edit one weakness.

Retrieve and reconnect

- Recall one benefit finding from W11L2.
- Recall one risk or uncertainty.
- State what DISCUSS requires.
- Lead-in: why must a conclusion follow the evidence?

Which opening best fits DISCUSS?

Think first. Point, say, sign or write your choice. Give one reason.

- A. Stem cells are cells. They divide.
- B. A possible benefit is..., while a possible risk or concern is...
- C. The answer is obvious and no evidence is needed.

Look closely · what is the evidence?

BENEFIT · supported possibility

RISK / CONCERN · harm or value

JUDGEMENT · justified and cautious

Look closely · what is the evidence?

BENEFIT
could replace damaged cells — 60% improved (simulated)

Benefit

RISK / CONCERN
15% side effects · source of cells · fairness of access

Risk

JUDGEMENT
"On this limited evidence, further controlled and longer trials are needed before..."

Judgement

Words we will use

- discuss — consider more than one side
- justify — give the evidence-based reason
- proportionate — matched to benefit and harm

Watch the model

- Read the command first: DISCUSS needs relevant considerations on more than one side.
- Build the answer: possible benefit with evidence; possible risk; ethical concern or uncertainty.
- Conclude with a condition: On this limited evidence, further controlled and longer-term study would be needed before a confident judgement.

Which sentence is a justified judgement rather than an unsupported opinion?

A. The evidence suggests possible benefit, but the short follow-up and adverse events mean a confident safety claim cannot yet be made.

B. I like stem cells, so the treatment is safe.

C. Some people disagree, so the science data do not matter.

Commit to an answer. Show the evidence you used. Listen, then revise if needed.

Build the explanation

- Audit the first draft: underline the evidence, box the risk or concern and circle the judgement.
- Receive one precise feedback point: missing side, unsupported claim, unclear command-word shape or overconfidence.
- Edit the same response, then state exactly what changed and why it is more scientific.

Find and repair the misconception

A balanced DISCUSS answer must say both sides are equally correct.

A. Keep it: balance means equal evidence.

B. Repair it: consider relevant sides, then weigh them according to evidence.

C. Repair it: replace evidence with personal preference.

DISCUSS answer-shape lab

Place each sentence in the role it performs, then repair the incomplete response.

- COMMAND
- EVIDENCE
- CONSIDER
- JUDGE
- EDIT

DISCUSS answer-shape lab

Use the numbered cards in your pupil pack. Take turns to choose, justify and check. You may direct a partner to move a card.

Choose a group · defend your placement

- BENEFIT + EVIDENCE
- RISK / CONCERN
- JUSTIFIED JUDGEMENT

Which part of the answer would you strengthen, and what exact edit will you make?

Your independent mission

DISCUSS: Based only on the simulated evidence, should this fictional stem-cell treatment proceed to a larger, longer controlled study? Write or dictate a judgement, receive one feedback point, then edit the same response.

Record: A balanced first response, one genuine audience comment, a visible edit and the pupil's statement of what changed.

Choose your support and challenge

- Supported: Choose one benefit, one risk/concern and one cautious conclusion; order them and add because.
- Standard: Write or dictate a structured DISCUSS paragraph, then make one evidence-led edit.
- Stretch: Weigh evidence, ethical concern and uncertainty, then edit an overclaim into a proportionate judgement.

Show what you know

What did you edit, and why is the new line more scientific?

Point to, read or explain the evidence you made. Choose one next step after the adult has listened.